

DIGITAL PHOTOGRAPHY

2026 & 2027 OFFICIAL RATING FORM

MIDDLE SCHOOL

Judges: Using minimal (1-4 points), adequate (5-8 points), or exemplary (9-10 points) performance levels as a guideline in the rating form, record the scores earned for the event criteria in the column spaces to the right. The X1 or X2 notation in the criteria column is a multiplier factor for determining the points earned. (Example: an "adequate" score of 7 for an X1 criterion = 7 points; an "adequate" score of 7 for an X2 criterion = 14 points.) A score of zero (0) is acceptable if the minimal performance for any criterion is not met.

Go/No Go Specifications

- Before judging the entry, ensure that the items below are present; indicate presence with a check mark in the box.
- If an item is missing, leave the box next to the item blank and place a check mark in the box labeled ENTRY NOT EVALUATED.
- If a check mark is placed in the ENTRY NOT EVALUATED box, the entry is not to be judged.

- ☐ Digital portfolio was submitted
- ☐ Consent/Release forms are present (if required)
- ☐ ENTRY NOT EVALUATED

DIGITAL PHOTOGRAPHIC PORTFOLIO (70 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance 1-4 points	Adequate performance 5-8 points	Exemplary performance 9-10 points	
Portfolio Components (X1)	Portfolio is unorganized and/or is missing three (3) or more components.	Portfolio is missing one (1) or two (2) components and/or is loosely organized.	Portfolio has all required components in order and is well organized.	
Principles and Elements of Design and Composition and Creativity (X2)	There is little or no evidence of an understanding or creative use of compositional elements (line, shape, form, value, space, texture, color, framing, emphasis, balance, unity, contrast, movement/rhythm and pattern/repetition).	Images demonstrate some knowledge and creative use of compositional elements (line, shape, form, value, space, texture, color, framing, emphasis, balance, unity, contrast, movement/rhythm and pattern/repetition).	Images clearly demonstrate excellent and creative use of a variety of compositional elements (line, shape, form, value, space, texture, color, framing, emphasis, balance, unity, contrast, movement/rhythm and pattern/repetition).	
Technical Quality (X1)	Photos are out of focus; blurriness is unintentional and does not contribute to the overall composition; photos display incorrect exposure values, white balance, and/or range of tones; there is little or no consideration given to lighting and/or special effects.	Photos are in focus; photos display correct exposure values, white balance, and/or range of tones; images exhibit some attention to lighting and/or the use of special effects.	Photo subject(s) are in sharp focus; blurriness is used effectively to enhance the composition; photos display correct exposure values, white balance, and/or range of tones; images are enhanced by attention to lighting and/or the use of special effects.	
Conveyance of the Theme (X1)	The images are flat and lack a clear connection to the theme; viewers are not drawn into the scene; images do not clearly convey the theme/challenge.	The images show some emotional depth; viewers make an emotional connection with the images/pictures and are drawn into the scene or learn something from the subject(s); images convey the competition theme/challenge.	The images show emotional depth; viewers make an instant emotional connection with the pictures and are drawn into the scene or learn something from the subject(s); images clearly convey the competition theme/challenge.	
Written Statements (X1)	A written statement may or may not accompany each photo, and/or the statement includes only some of the photo's meta data (camera make/model, f/stop, exposure time, ISO speed, focal length), and/or an explanation of the relevance of the image to the challenge is not present and/or is written poorly.	A written statement accompanies each photo; the statement includes most of the photo's meta data (camera make/model, f/stop, exposure time, ISO speed, focal length); an explanation of the relevance of the image to the challenge is included.	A written statement accompanies each photo; the statement includes the photo's meta data (camera make/model, f/stop, exposure time, ISO speed, focal length); an explanation of the relevance of the image to the challenge is presented in a clear and concise manner.	

DIGITAL PHOTOGRAPHIC PORTFOLIO (70 points) – continued				
Resources (X1)	A resources list is present, but graphic and/or software packages used are not mentioned.	A resources list is present and the primary software packages used are included; contains an adequate list of resources.	Detailed and concise resources are provided; all software packages used are included.	
DIGITAL PHOTOGRAPHIC PORTFOLIO SUBTOTAL (70 points)				
Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____				

PRELIMINARY SUBTOTAL (70 points)

SEMIFINAL CHALLENGE (70 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Principles and Elements of Design/Composition and Creativity (X2)	There is little or no evidence of an understanding or creative use of compositional elements (line, shape, form, value, space, texture, color, framing, emphasis, balance, unity, contrast, movement/rhythm and pattern/repetition).	Images demonstrate some knowledge and creative use of compositional elements (line, shape, form, value, space, texture, color, framing, emphasis, balance, unity, contrast, movement/rhythm and pattern/repetition).	Images clearly demonstrate excellent and creative use of a variety of compositional elements (line, shape, form, value, space, texture, color, framing, emphasis, balance, unity, contrast, movement/rhythm and pattern/repetition).	
Technical Skill (X2)	Participants do not demonstrate knowledge of and understanding of how to utilize photographic equipment and techniques; participants show little or no creativity in staging and photographing subjects.	Participants demonstrate some knowledge of and an understanding of how to utilize photographic equipment and techniques, or use it only minimally in the on-site challenge; participants show some creativity in staging and photographing subjects.	Participants clearly demonstrate knowledge and understanding of how to utilize photographic equipment and techniques; participants show creativity in staging and photographing subjects; participants show a high level of skill in the use of the tools to create high quality images.	
Technical Quality (X1)	Photos are out of focus; blurriness is unintentional and does not contribute to the overall composition; photos display incorrect exposure values, white balance, and/or range of tones; there is little or no consideration given to lighting and/or special effects.	Photos are in focus; photos display correct exposure values, white balance, and/or range of tones; images exhibit some attention to lighting and/or the use of special effects.	Photo subject(s) are in sharp focus; blurriness is used effectively to enhance the composition; photos display correct exposure values, white balance, and/or range of tones; images are enhanced by attention to lighting and/or the use of special effects.	
Impact and Theme (X1)	The images are flat and lack emotional depth; viewers are not drawn into the scene; images do not clearly convey the theme/challenge.	The images show some emotional depth; viewers make an emotional connection with the images/pictures and are drawn into the scene or learn something from the subject(s); images convey the competition theme/challenge.	The images show emotional depth; viewers make an instant emotional connection with the pictures and are drawn into the scene or learn something from the subject(s); images clearly convey the competition theme/challenge.	

SEMIFINAL CHALLENGE (70 points) – continued				
Written Statements (X1)	A written statement may or may not accompany each photo, and/or the statement includes only some of the photo's meta data (camera make/model, f/stop, exposure time, ISO speed, focal length), and/or an explanation of the relevance of the image to the challenge is not present and/or is written poorly.	A written statement accompanies each photo; the statement includes most of the photo's meta data (camera make/model, f/stop, exposure time, ISO speed, focal length); an explanation of the relevance of the image to the challenge is included.	A written statement accompanies each photo; the statement includes the photo's meta data (camera make/model, f/stop, exposure time, ISO speed, focal length); an explanation of the relevance of the image to the challenge is presented in a clear and concise manner.	
SEMIFINAL CHALLENGE SUBTOTAL (70 points)				

SEMIFINAL PRESENTATION/INTERVIEW (50 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Organization Use of visual materials (X1)	Participant seems unorganized and unprepared for the presentation; illogical explanation of the photographs and/or stylistic elements is presented.	Participant is generally prepared for the presentation; explanation of photographs and/or stylistic elements is communicated and somewhat organized.	The presentation is logical, well organized, and easy to follow; explanation of the photographs and/or stylistic elements are communicated in an organized and concise manner.	
Knowledge (X1)	Participant seems to have little understanding of the stylistic photographic elements used.	Participant exhibits an understanding of the stylistic photographic elements used in their project; the presentation is for the most part, logical and/or clear.	Participants show clear evidence of a thorough understanding of the stylistic photographic elements; the presentation is concise and logical.	
Articulation (X1)	Communication of the design process is unclear, unorganized, and or illogical; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are not evident.	Communication of the design process is somewhat logical and clear; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are somewhat evident.	Communication of the design process is clear, concise, and logical; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are clearly evident.	
Integration of Theme (X1)	The current theme is not demonstrated in the product.	The current theme is adequately demonstrated in the product.	The current theme is exceptionally well demonstrated in the product.	
Delivery (X1)	The participant is verbose and/or uncertain in his/her presentation/interview; participants' posture, gestures, and lack of eye contact diminish the presentation/interview.	The participant is somewhat well-spoken and clear in his/her presentation/interview; participants' posture, gestures, and eye contact are acceptable in the presentation/interview.	The participant is well-spoken and distinct in its presentation/interview; the participants' posture, gestures, and eye contact result in a polished, natural, and effective presentation/interview.	
SEMIFINAL PRESENTATION/INTERVIEW SUBTOTAL (50 points)				

Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____	
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SEMIFINAL SUBTOTAL (120 points)	
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To arrive at the TOTAL score, add any subtotals and subtract rules violation points, as necessary.	TOTAL (190 points)	
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Comments:

I certify these results to be true and accurate to the best of my knowledge.

JUDGE

Printed name: _____ Signature: _____